

BaRS API Standard and Wayfinder Producer Specification Gap Analysis

Referrals and Appointments

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This page primarily focuses on the differences between the BaRS API Standard and the Wayfinder Producer Specification.

1 Use of Resources Types

BaRS facilitates booking/referral workflows and supports many resource types than Wayfinder.

Resource	Supported by BaRS Standard	Supported by Wayfinder Producer Specification	Notes
Bundle	Yes	Yes	BaRS: Vital for messaging using BaRS Proxy and BaRS Apps
MessageHeader	Yes	No	BaRS: Vital for messaging using BaRS Proxy and BaRS Apps
Appointment	Yes	Yes	
DocumentReference	Yes	Yes	BaRS: Used in as discovery mechanism / registry pattern Wayfinder: Used as a link for jumping off to PEP UI to surface documents to patient
Task	No	Yes	Wayfinder: Used as a link for jumping off to a PEP UI to surface questionnaires to patients
Service Request	Yes	Yes	BaRS: Used for Referrals workflows Wayfinder: Used to map referral information from eRS to the NHS App
Slot	Yes	No	Wayfinder: No use for it currently e.g. slot polling / management
Schedule	Yes	No	Wayfinder: No use for it currently e.g. slot polling / management
Patient	Yes	Partial	BaRS: Mandatory patient resource. Wayfinder: References patient via NHS Number as an appointment participant actor - required
Organization	Yes	Partial	Wayfinder: References organization via ODS code as an appointment participant actor - required

Resource	Supported by BaRS Standard	Supported by Wayfinder Producer Specification	Notes
Location	Yes	Partial	Wayfinder: References location via free-text description as an appointment participant actor - optional
HealthcareService	Yes	Partial	Wayfinder: References healthcare services via codes as an appointment participant actor for both PAS/EPR, PEP and eRS systems - optional
Practitioner	Yes	Partial	Wayfinder: References clinician via SDS codes as an appointment participant actor - optional
PractitionerRole	Yes	No	

2 Appointment Listing Pattern

Wayfinder calls external systems directly for all appointments relating to a patient while BaRS is workflow specific.

API	BaRS usage	Wayfinder usage	Notes
GET / DocumentReference	BaRS List function from this API to the registry (NRL) to retrieve pointers for existing appointments.	Not used for appointment retrieval.	
GET / Appointment	GET /Appointment/{id} to retrieve a specific appointment,	Used to get all appointments related to the NHS Number	singular vs plural get

3 Appointment resource attribute differences

Attribute	BaRS Standard	Wayfinder Producer Specification	Notes
Extensions	None – uses only base UKCore-Appointment fields	4 custom extensions • priority • request status • consultation medium • portal link	Non-standard; not in the BaRS specification
identifier[]	Not typically present	Two identifiers • clinical system ID • portal ID	BaRS uses <code>id</code> as the primary key, not business identifiers on the Appointment
basedOn[]	Not present in Standard Pattern	References a UBRN, clinical system ServiceRequest ID, and a Pathway ID	BaRS Standard Pattern has no concept of linking Appointments to ServiceRequests via <code>basedOn</code> – this is an e-RS/elective care concept
slot[]	Required – references the booked Slot	Optional	BaRS requires a Slot reference
participant actors	Patient only (with NHS Number + display name)	• Patient • Attending Clinician (SDS Id) • Locations (ODS code) • Location (free-text location) • Healthcare Service (Portal) • Healthcare Service (Source System - PAS/EPR) • Healthcare Service (eRS Id)	BaRS Standard Pattern only requires the Patient participant
participant.actor structure	Uses <code>reference</code> (resource URL) + <code>identifier</code>	Uses <code>type</code> + <code>identifier</code> (no <code>reference</code> URL)	BaRS expects a resolvable <code>reference</code> ; Wayfinder uses a logical identifier pattern instead
created	Present (when the booking was made)	Missing	BaRS includes <code>created</code> as standard

Attribute	BaRS Standard	Wayfinder Producer Specification	Notes
meta.profile	Declares UKCore-Appointment	Missing	No profile declaration – can't confirm conformance
meta.lastUpdated	Present	Missing	No versioning information
description	Clinical reason for the appointment	"Dermatology" (specialty, not reason)	Used differently – specialty rather than presenting complaint
fullUrl	Points to BaRS Proxy (int.api.service.nhs.uk/booking-and-referral/1...)	Points to a third-party portal (fhir.patientportal.co.uk/2...)	Not served through the BaRS Proxy

3.1 Extensions not in BaRS

Extension	Purpose	BaRS equivalent
Extension-ServiceRequest-Priority	eRS Appointment priority (ROUTINE/URGENT/TWO WEEK WAIT)	Not on Appointment – priority lives on ServiceRequest in BaRS
Extension-Appointment-RequestStatus	Request (asynchronous) workflow state e.g. Request to reschedule or cancel appointment	Not applicable – BaRS uses FHIR <code>status</code> field only
Extension-Consultation-Medium	Virtual/face-to-face Note: in process to be uplifted to support Video and Telephone. Virtual to be deprecated but remains for existing PEP compatibility	Not currently in BaRS Standard Pattern

1. <http://int.api.service.nhs.uk/booking-and-referral/>

2. <http://fhir.patientportal.co.uk/>

Extension	Purpose	BaRS equivalent
Extension-Portal-Link	Patient-facing deep-link URL for the appointment/document/questionnaire	Not in BaRS – this is a consumer/portal concern

3.2 basedOn not used in BaRS

The `basedOn` array links the Appointment to:

- A UBRN (e-RS referral identifier)
- A clinical system ServiceRequest ID
- A Pathway ID

BaRS Standard Pattern Appointments are standalone – they reference a Slot. If a BaRS Application links a booking to a referral, it uses `$process-message` with a full message Bundle, not `basedOn` on the Appointment resource.

4 Summary

Wayfinder Producer Specification is not BaRS conformant. It is FHIR R4 but using artefacts not defined in UK Core.

To make this interoperable with BaRS, the system would need to:

1. Wayfinder to resolve the custom extensions to be BaRS compliant - remove or work with IOPS and propose them for inclusion in the standard
2. Wayfinder to resolve the differences on `reference` URLs in participant actors vs `type` + `identifier`
3. BaRS to consider whether `basedOn` should be adopted into the BaRS Standard Pattern for elective care use cases
4. BaRS to consider whether to allow plural GET /Appointment call.
5. Wayfinder to add `meta.profile` declaring UKCore-Appointment conformance - once it is UKCore / BaRS compliant